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Instrument 9 — Founder Red Flags *(Chapters 11–12, 15)*

Platform language before wedge durability. Pilot counts offered where renewal counts were asked for. Burden questions answered with pricing slides. Compliance treated as the customer's problem. Resentment of the courtship — references, advisors, accelerator vetting — that first health-system relationships legitimately require. Heroics presented as repeatable product performance. Expansion that happens only where the sales team pushes. A market map where the diligence question was about one buyer's coalition. And the meta-flag that contains the others: the inability to answer, simply, *what are you trying to accomplish, and how does this actually get you there?*